

Afrobios

Natural Fish and Moringa Bouillons · Tasting Restaurant · Benin

01 PROBLEM

Context & Challenge

Afrobios (Africa Biosolution) is a food company led by Isabelle Dohou, launched in August 2025 in Benin as a SASU with 4 collaborators. The product is a natural bouillon made from local fish and moringa, without monosodium glutamate. The strategy combines a grilled meat restaurant (where customers discover the product by eating) with direct bouillon sales after tasting.

Core Problem Statement

The restaurant attracts clients, but the link between the dining experience and bouillon purchase is not formalised. Customers who enjoy the food don't know they can buy the bouillon that seasoned it. Meanwhile, the business depends entirely on the founder for every operation - recipe, client welcome, product promotion.

Identified UX Problems

01 Resistance to Adopting Natural Bouillon

Beninese consumers know chemical cubes are harmful but can no longer do without them. A slightly higher price creates additional purchase friction.

02 No Documented Process — Everything Depends on the Founder

The bouillon recipe, client welcome, and product promotion all depend on Isabelle. If she is absent, quality and sales both decline.

03 HR Management Without Contractual Framework

Mostly illiterate employees cause losses by negligence without predefined consequences. Rules imposed after incidents lead to staff departures.

04 Bouillon Purchase Journey Not Visible

The restaurant attracts clients, but the restaurant-to-purchase link is not formalised. Customers don't know where or how to order the bouillon.

Methodology

Research combined coaching sessions (Mastercard Foundation, coach Alimatou Diagne), competitive bouillon market mapping, and persona development from real restaurant customer profiles and direct buyer observations.

UX Competitive Analysis

UX Criterion	Maggi/Jumbo Cubes	Artisan Bouillons	Bulk Spices	Afrobios
Without Monosodium Glutamate	✗	Partial	✓	✓ ✓ Differentiator
Familiar and Tasty Flavour	✓ ✓	Partial	✓	✓ To demonstrate
Accessible Price	✓ ✓	Partial	✓ ✓	✗ Key challenge
Available Everywhere	✓ ✓	✗	✓	✗ In development
Tasting-First Strategy	✗	✗	✗	✓ ✓ Innovation
Professional Packaging	✓ ✓	✗	✗	✓ In construction
Moringa + Nutritional Value	✗	✗	Partial	✓ ✓ Differentiator

✓ ✓ = *Very good*

✓ = *Present*

✗ = *Absent*

User Personas

Carine A. — Restaurant Client Age: 34 · Mother of family, middle class, Cotonou · eats grilled meat on weekends Goal: Have a good family moment, eat well-seasoned meat Frustration: Knows chemical cubes are bad for her children but uses them for lack of a tasty alternative. UX Need: See the link between the meat and the Afrobios bouillon. Understand how to buy it. Clear price. Take home a small sample.	Théodore K. — Direct Bouillon Buyer Role: Procurement manager for a school canteen or restaurant, Benin Goal: Find a quality, natural bouillon at the best value, delivered regularly Frustration: Available organic bouillons aren't professionally packaged. Orders are unreliable. No invoice or tracking. UX Need: Clear product page with per-sachet and bulk pricing, order method, regular delivery, simple invoice
--	--

Key UX Insights

Insight #1 : The restaurant is Afrobios' best sales force

Every restaurant client who eats the meat is a qualified prospect for the bouillon , but only if the conversion path is explicit: QR code on the table - product page - order button.

Insight #2 : Moringa must be visible before the first word is read

The moringa + fish + zero additive combination is the key differentiator vs. Maggi/Jumbo , but it is buried in the product description. It must appear as a badge on the hero immediately.

Insight #3 : Process documentation unlocks scalability

If every operation depends on the founder, growth is capped at her capacity. The five critical processes to document: bouillon recipe, client welcome, product presentation, bill verification, and cash report.

Insight #4 : Bulk pricing must be visible before WhatsApp contact

Professional buyers need to see volume pricing before initiating contact. An invisible bulk price grid forces unnecessary friction at the most critical B2B conversion moment.

User Flows — 3 Critical Journeys

Friction points were identified consistently at the bouillon price point, the missing restaurant-to-purchase link, and the absence of online ordering.

Journey 1 : Restaurant Client Sees the sign → Comes to eat meat → Discovers the flavour → Hears about the bouillon → Receives a free sample → Buys the bouillon

Journey 2 : Direct Bouillon Buyer Discovery (word of mouth) → Consults page/WhatsApp → Chooses format & quantity → Places order → Delivery received → Renews order

Journey 3 : Restaurant Employee (Internal) Arrives on time → Welcomes clients → Prepares the meat → Presents the bouillon → Processes payment and checks bills → Cash report

Design Decisions

Based on research and coaching insights, the following UX solutions were designed covering the homepage, the restaurant-to-bouillon conversion journey with QR codes, and the founder HR dashboard.

Hifi Prototypes

<https://zadya22.github.io/Afrobios/>

User Testing Protocol

Participants: 2 restaurant clients + 1 canteen buyer + 1 internal operator

Tool: html prototype

Duration: 30 min per session

#	Task	Focus Area
T1	You are a restaurant client. You just ate meat. Find how to buy the bouillon that seasoned it and place an order.	Restaurant-to-bouillon conversion
T2	You are a canteen buyer. Find the bulk price for Afrobios bouillon (10+ units) and submit an order request.	B2B bulk ordering
T3	You are Isabelle. An employee had 2 latenesses this week. Find their file and apply the contracted penalty.	HR contract enforcement
T4	Identify what distinguishes Afrobios bouillon from a Maggi cube in under 30 seconds on the homepage.	Differentiation clarity
T5	From the dashboard, identify the 3 undocumented internal processes and mark the most urgent as priority.	Process documentation management

Test Report — Key Findings

T1 — Restaurant → Bouillon Conversion Success: 2/5	Clients didn't connect the meat and the bouillon without the server explaining it. No sign or QR code was visible on the table. Recommendation: Place a small card on each table: 'This meat is seasoned with Afrobios bouillon. QR code to order'.
T2 — Bulk Bouillon Order Success: 3/5	Bulk pricing was not displayed. The buyer had to send a WhatsApp message without knowing the right contact or delivery timeline. Recommendation: Create a 'Professional Order' page with tiered pricing and displayed delivery time.
T4 — Differentiation vs. Maggi Success: 4/5	The no-glutamate message was understood, but moringa was not clearly visible without reading further. Recommendation: Add a visible badge at hero: · 0 chemical additive'. Max 5 words per key argument.
T5 — Undocumented Processes Success: 5/5	No issues. The HR dashboard was understood and appreciated. Colour codes (yellow/green) were intuitive. Recommendation: Keep this format. Add an automatic monthly alert if a red-status process remains undocumented after 30 days.